PREMIUM COURSE MATERIAL

MODULE 3
LESSON 2

Prompt Engineering & Editing AI Images

Learn the essentials of prompt engineering & editing ai images

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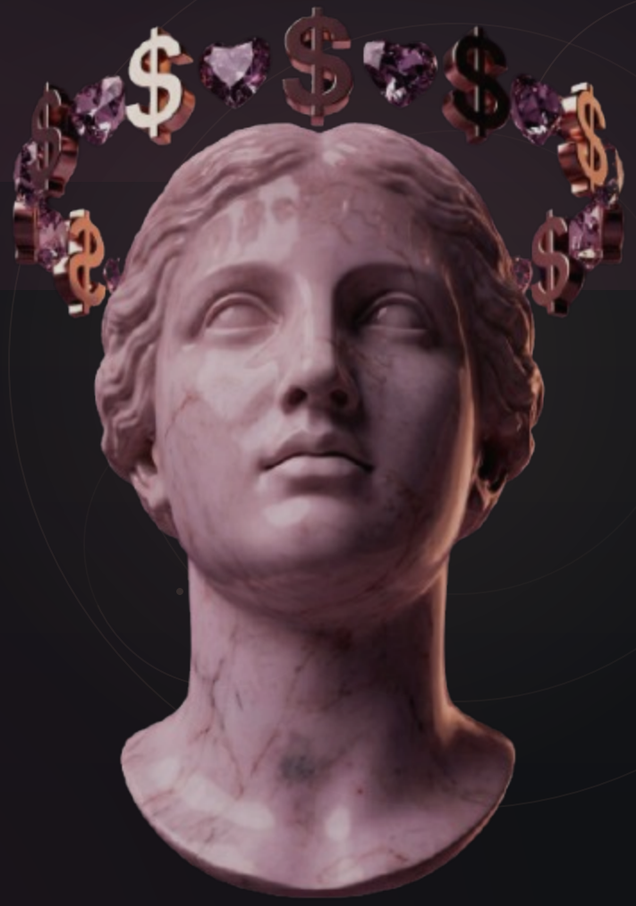

LESSON 2: PROMPT ENGINEERING & EDITING AI IMAGES

Why JSON Prompts Beat Traditional Prompts

Your prompt is everything. JSON prompts are the best way to prompt because they carry far more data about posing, lighting, camera settings, and environment than a traditional text prompt ever could. A JSON prompt specifies exact depth of field, shadow behavior, color temperature, and composition — details that get lost in a one-line text prompt. The AI gets structured instructions for every aspect of the image instead of guessing.

BAD EXAMPLE:

Traditional prompt:
'Woman walking on city street, blue gingham outfit, sunny day, fashion photography, photorealistic'

This tells the AI nothing about pose, lighting direction, camera angle, depth of field, color grading, or composition. You get random results every time.

GOOD EXAMPLE:

JSON prompt advantage:
→ Composition: exact framing, crop, camera angle, depth of field
→ Subject: specific wardrobe details, expression, gesture
→ Environment: location elements, architectural details
→ Lighting: source, direction, color temperature, shadow behavior
→ Technical: focal length, aperture, ISO, sharpness
→ Artistic: aesthetic, mood, stylistic influences, texture rendering

Every detail is specified — nothing is left to chance.

Example JSON Prompt

EXAMPLE JSON PROMPT:

```
{
  "prompt_modifiers": ["character from reference images"],
  "image_type": "outdoor fashion street portrait",
  "composition": {
    "framing": "vertical, mid-thigh crop",
    "camera_angle": "eye-level perspective",
    "pose": "walking forward on sidewalk, torso facing camera",
    "depth_of_field": "moderate, subject sharp, background blurred"
  },
  "subject": {
    "wardrobe": "blue gingham button-up top, matching mini skirt, brown suede handbag",
    "expression": "composed, neutral with soft direct gaze"
  },
  "environment": {
    "location_type": "urban street setting",
    "elements": ["storefront windows", "stone facade", "paved sidewalk"],
    "style": "luxury shopping district"
  },
  "lighting": {
    "source": "natural direct sunlight",
    "direction": "front-side from upper left",
    "color_temperature": "warm daylight (~5600K)",
    "shadows": "soft shadow outlines on ground"
  },
  "technical_characteristics": {
    "focal_length": "28-35mm",
    "aperture": "f/2.8-f/4",
    "sharpness": "high with clear fabric texture"
  },
  "artistic_elements": {
    "aesthetic": "chic European summer street style",
    "mood": "confident, polished, effortless"
  }
}
```

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How to Generate JSON Prompts

- → Find your reference image on Pinterest
- → Feed it into an AI and ask it to generate a JSON prompt describing everything about the image
- → The AI breaks down pose, lighting, environment, camera settings, and style into structured JSON
- → Feed that JSON prompt into Nano Banana 2 along with your base model image
- → The output matches the reference's pose and lighting — but with your AI model

> **PRO TIP**
>
> Save every JSON prompt that produces good results. Build a library organized by scene type (street, cafe, gym, beach, home, etc.). When you need new content, grab a working JSON prompt, swap out the wardrobe and environment details, and generate. This is how you produce dozens of images efficiently without starting from scratch.

Raw AI outputs are rarely perfect. Even the best generations need minor editing before they are ready to post. This lesson covers what to look for, how to fix common issues, and the critical trick that makes AI images pass as real photos. Skipping the editing step is how pages get exposed as AI.

Common Issues to Fix

- Extra or distorted fingers/hands — the most common AI artifact
- Asymmetric facial features — one eye larger or different height
- Text or watermark artifacts in background — AI loves generating fake text
- Unnatural skin smoothing or plastic shine — too perfect is too fake
- Weird jewelry, accessories, or clothing seams that break reality
- Background inconsistencies — impossible geometry, blending errors, floating objects

Editing Workflow

- → Step 1: Inspect hands and fingers first (most common issue)
- → Step 2: Check face symmetry and eye alignment
- → Step 3: Scan background for text, artifacts, or impossible geometry
- → Step 4: Adjust color grading for natural skin tones
- → Step 5: Add approximately 2% grain/noise for realism (critical step)
- → Step 6: Crop or reframe for platform-specific aspect ratios
- → Step 7: Export at appropriate resolution

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Editing Tools (Free Options)

- Photopea (photopea.com) — Free browser-based Photoshop alternative. Handles everything you need
- GIMP — Free desktop app for advanced editing
- Canva — Basic cropping, filters, and text overlay
- Snapseed — Mobile editing for quick adjustments
- For most editing tasks, Photopea is all you need

> **IMAGE PLACEHOLDER**
>
> Before/after examples of common AI artifacts being fixed: distorted hand corrected, background text removed, skin smoothing reduced, asymmetric eyes fixed

The Grain Trick — Critical

This is the single most important editing technique in this entire course. Raw AI images look too clean, too smooth, too perfect. Real photos from phones have subtle grain and noise. Adding approximately 2% grain in your editing tool makes AI images pass as real.

- In Photopea: Filter → Noise → Add Noise → set to 2-3%, Gaussian, Monochromatic
- This simulates camera sensor noise that exists in every real photo
- Without grain, experienced eyes can spot AI images immediately
- The difference is subtle but it is the difference between 'this looks real' and 'this looks AI'
- Apply grain as the very last step before export

> **IMAGE PLACEHOLDER**
>
> Side by side comparison: Raw AI output (too smooth, no grain, plastic-looking) vs Edited output (grain added, color corrected, natural-looking). Label the differences clearly.

Nano Banana 2 Edit Feature — Fixing Specific Areas

When a generated image is almost perfect but has one bad area (a distorted hand, a weird background element), use the edit feature in Nano Banana 2 to fix just that area without regenerating the entire image.

- Use the edit feature in Nano Banana 2 to select the problem area
- Write a prompt describing what should be in that area
- Nano Banana 2 regenerates only the selected region while keeping everything else
- This saves images that would otherwise be rejected entirely
- Use it for: hands, background artifacts, clothing seams, jewelry errors

> **RULE**
>
> Do not over-edit. The goal is to fix obvious AI artifacts and add grain, not to create a heavily processed image. Over-edited photos look fake in a different way. Fix the problems, add grain, and stop. Natural-looking beats polished-looking every time.

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END SUMMARY

- Always generate new images using your base model as a reference in Nano Banana 2
- Write detailed prompts with setting, lighting, outfit, and camera angle — save templates that produce good results
- Use Photopea (free) to export Instagram carousels — this helps avoid the AI filter on Instagram
- Always add approximately 2% grain/noise as the final editing step — this is what makes AI images pass as real photos
- Use the edit feature in Nano Banana 2 to fix specific problem areas without regenerating the entire image
- Know each platform's content rules — TikTok and Instagram are strictest, Reddit is most flexible
- When in doubt, keep it safe — a content strike can derail weeks of progress

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